



Reading: Exemplar: Using logs to help you track down an issue in Windows

Introduction

In this lab, you used logs to help you troubleshoot and track down an issue. As an IT Support Specialist, it's crucial that you know how to troubleshoot and "follow the cookie crumbs." There were five different issues that you resolved using the skills you learned so far in this course.

This exemplar is a walk-through of the previous Qwiklab activity, including detailed instructions and solutions. You may use this exemplar if you were unable to complete the lab and/or you need extra guidance in competing lab tasks. You may also refer to this exemplar to prepare for the graded quiz in this module.

What you'll do

Here are the concepts you need to be familiar with before taking this lab:

- Updating software that's out-of-date
- Finding and deleting files
- Modifying file permissions
- Finding and terminating specific processes

Scenario

Your computer is having some issues and you can't seem to figure out what's wrong. Argh! Dig through the logs to figure out how to fix these issues.

You'll use logs to identify issues on a Windows VM, which you'll then fix using the knowledge you've gained from the other labs that you've completed.

Start the lab

You'll need to start the lab before you can access the materials. To do this, click the green **Start Lab** button at the top of the screen.

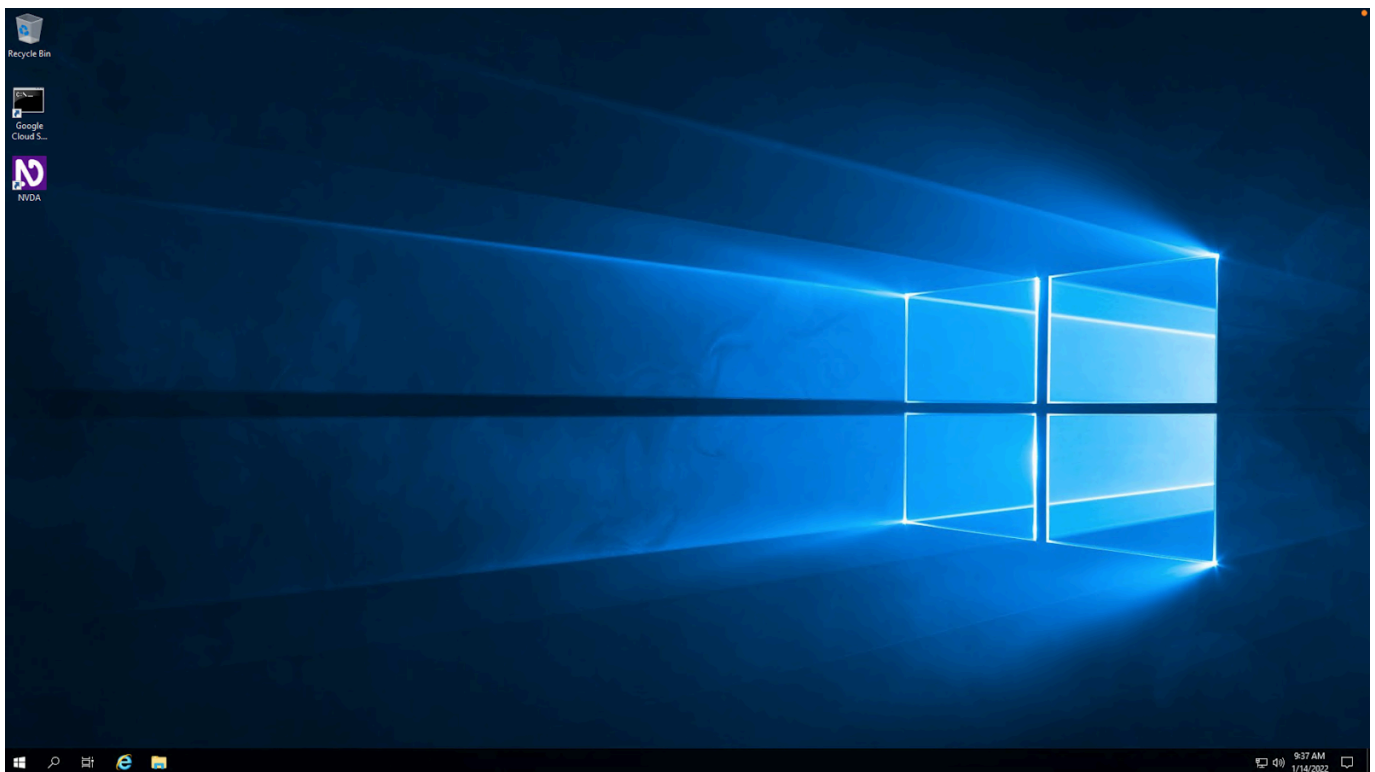
A green rectangular button with rounded corners and the text "Start Lab" in white.

After you click the **Start Lab** button, you will see a panel appear below where the start lab button was that has an **Open Windows VM** button.

Caution: When you are in the console, do not deviate from the lab instructions. Doing so may cause your account to be blocked.
[Learn more.](#)

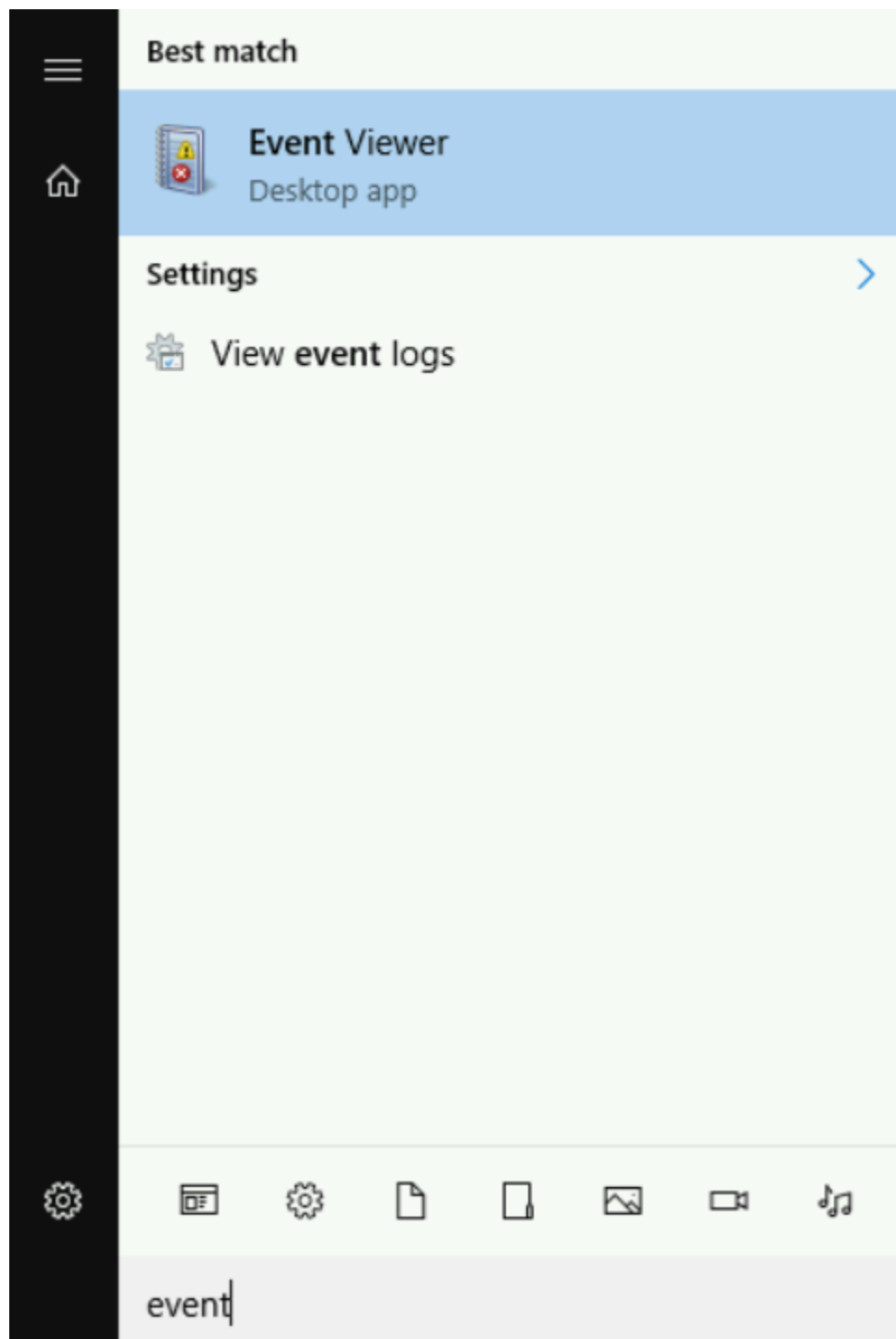
Open Windows VM

Click the **Open Windows VM** button and a new tab will open with a visual interface for Windows OS, where you will be performing further steps in the lab. You should have a visual interface for Windows that looks like this:

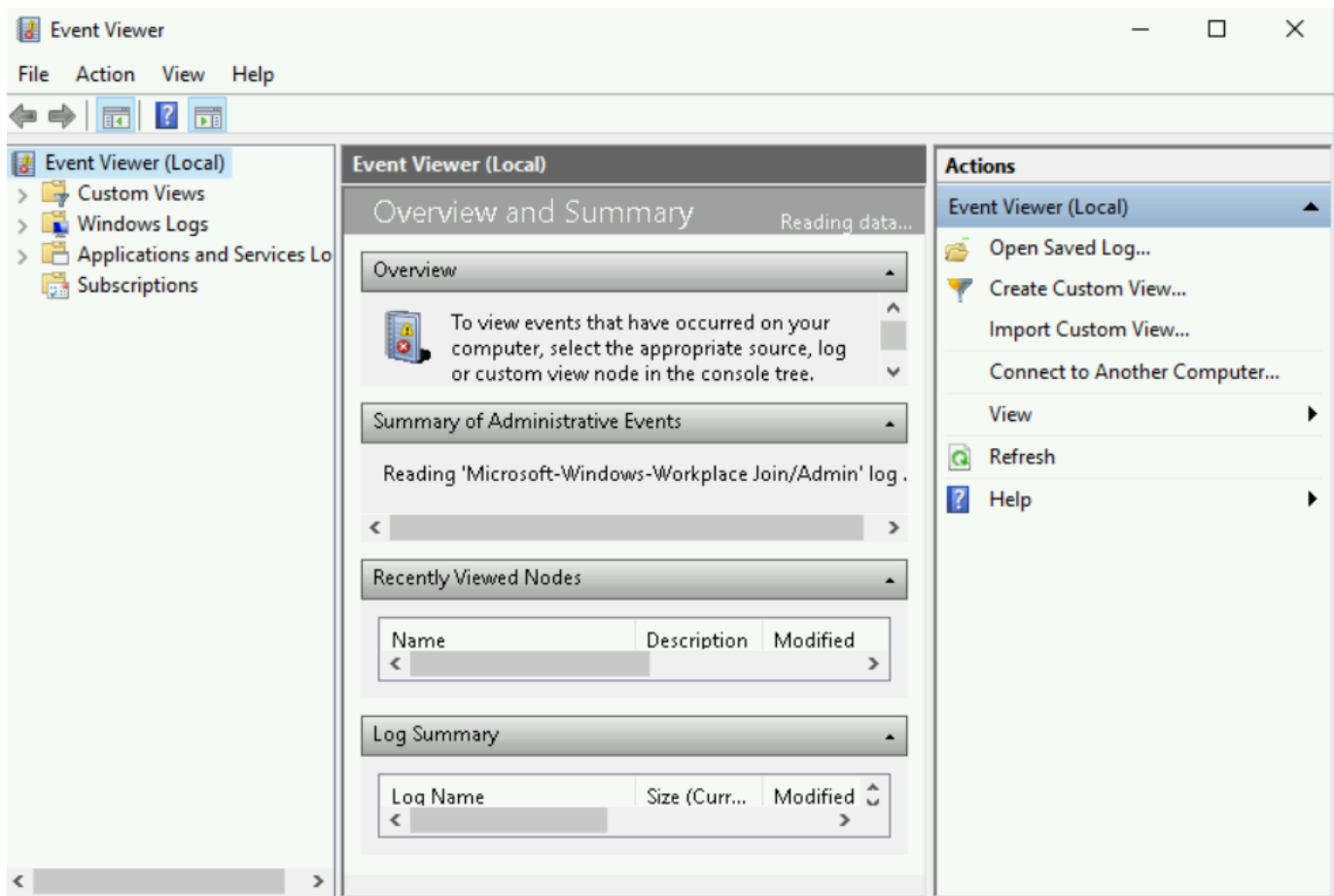


Viewing logs on Windows

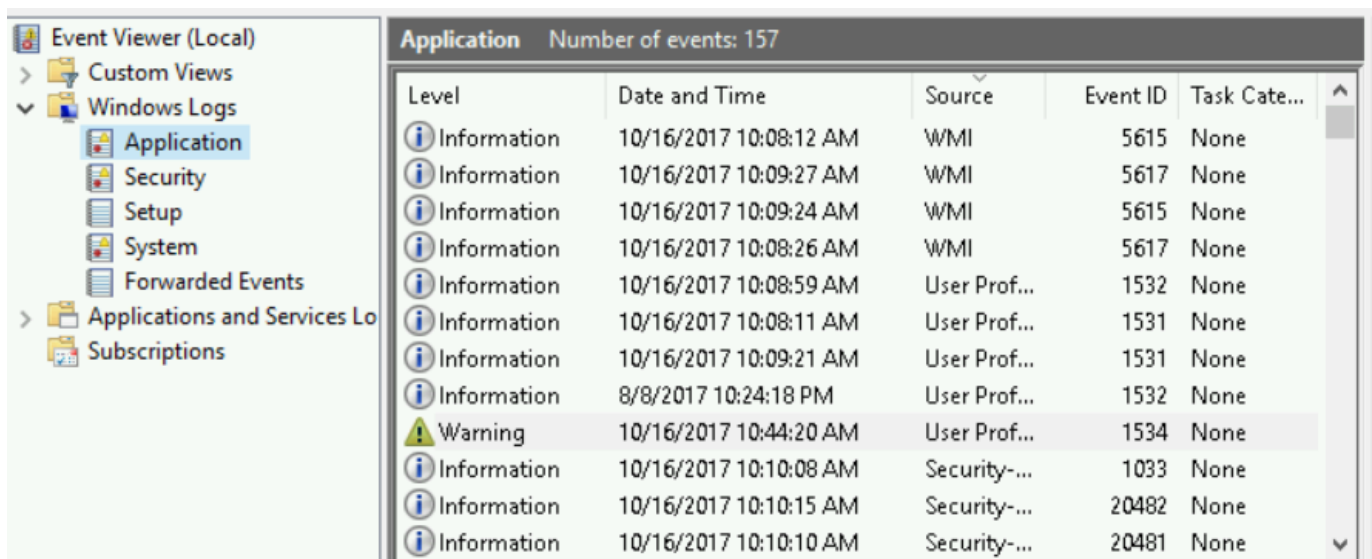
To view logs on Windows, you should use the **Event Viewer** application. To open **Event Viewer**, open the **Start** menu and search for "event viewer". The application icon should look like the image below. Click it to open the application.



Once open, it should look like this:



Feel free to resize the window at any time, to make the text easier to read. Next, click on the **Windows Logs** folder in the far-left column. Then, select **Application** to view the application logs, where the logs for this lab are located:

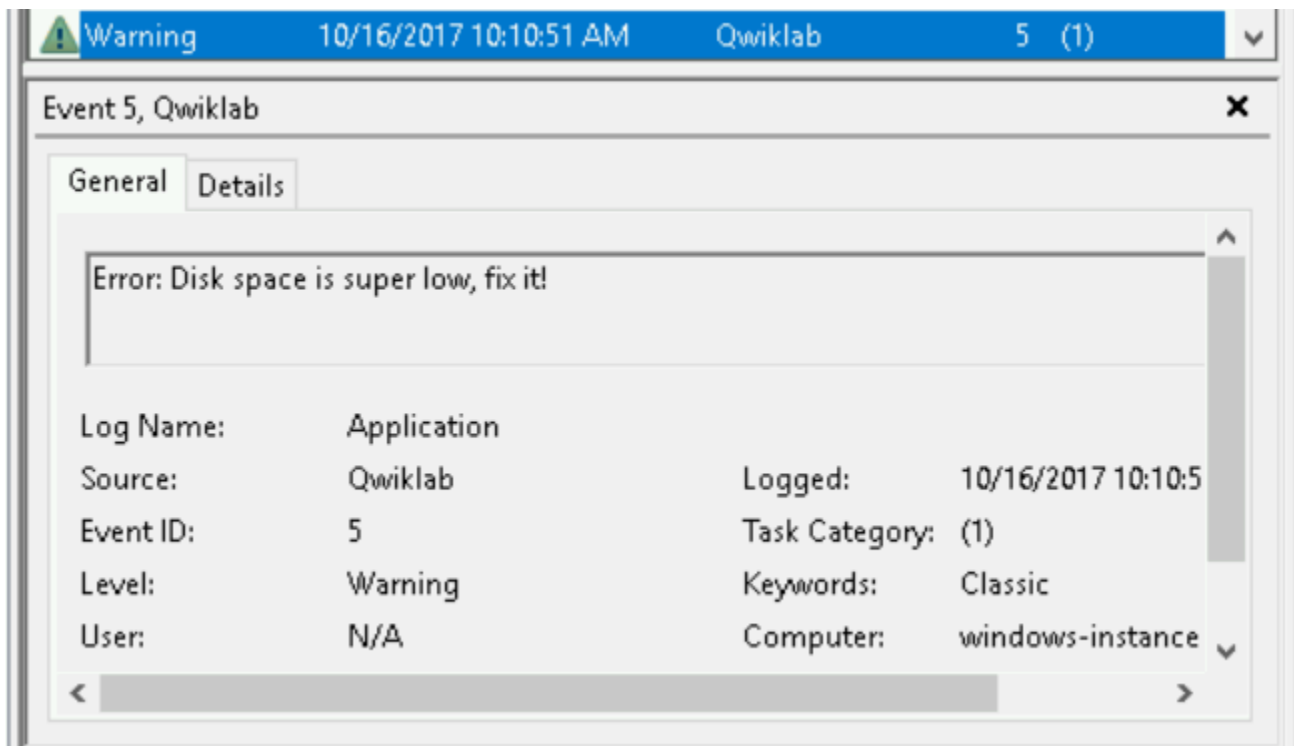


Scroll through the logs to find the five logs that you need to fix for this lab. They should have a time that's close to when you started the lab, and the **Source** field should be **Qwiklab**. To view details of a log entry, click on it in **Event Viewer**, and a message window will open at the bottom of the **Event Viewer** window.

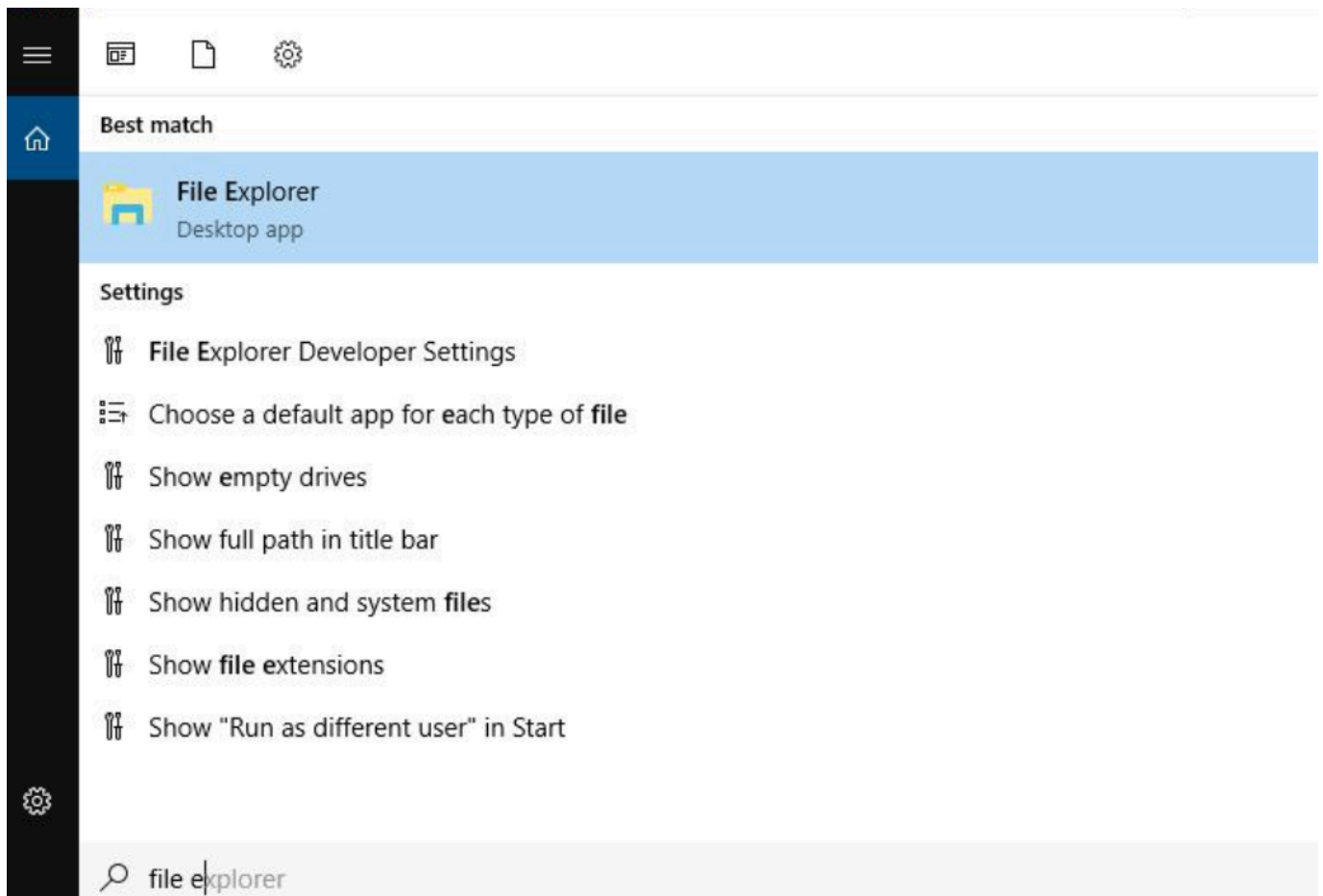
We'll walk through one of the logs, then the other four will be up to you. You're on your own... but you've got this!

Low disk space!

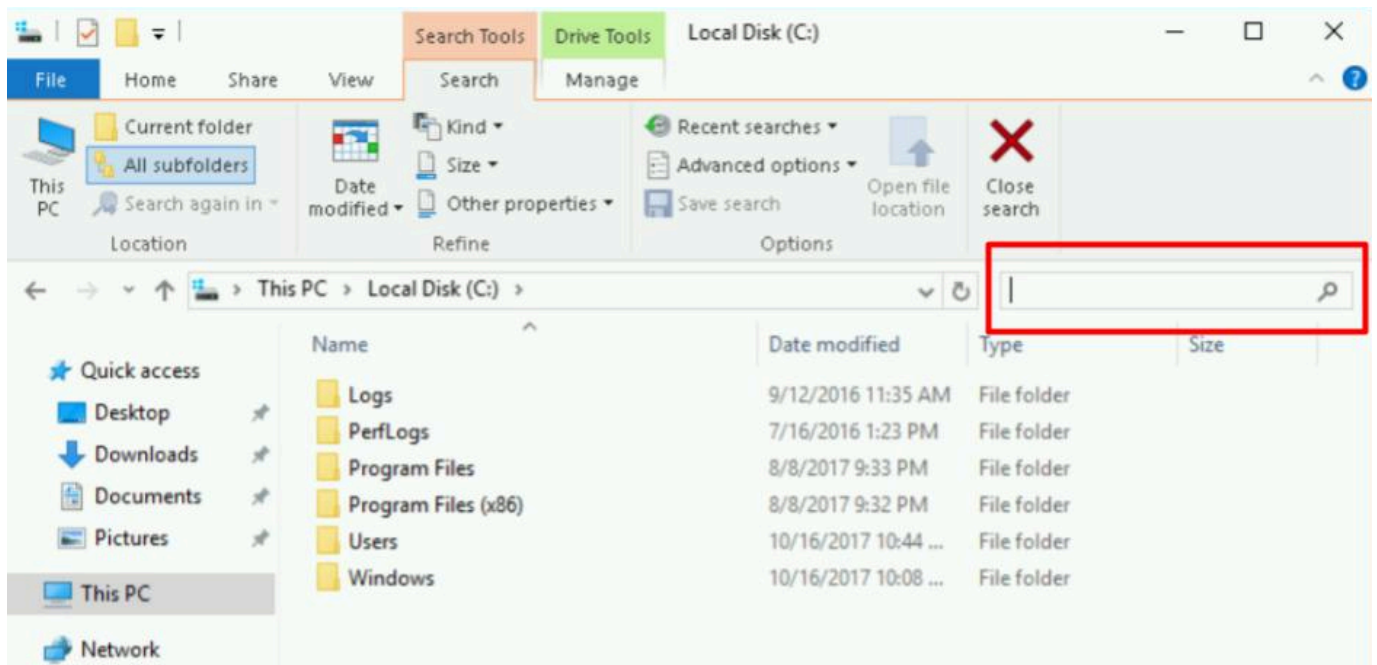
Find and click on the log with **Qwiklab** as the source and **Event ID 5**:



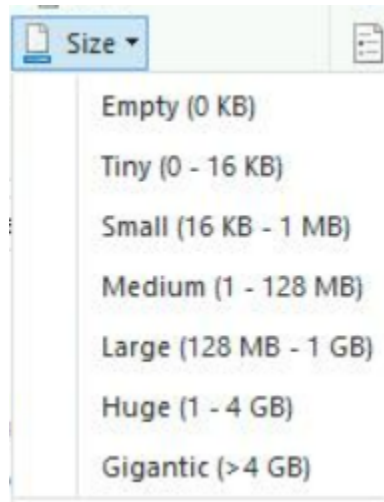
This log is warning you about a large file that's taking up disk space, but it doesn't specify the file name. On Windows, you can find large files using the File Explorer.



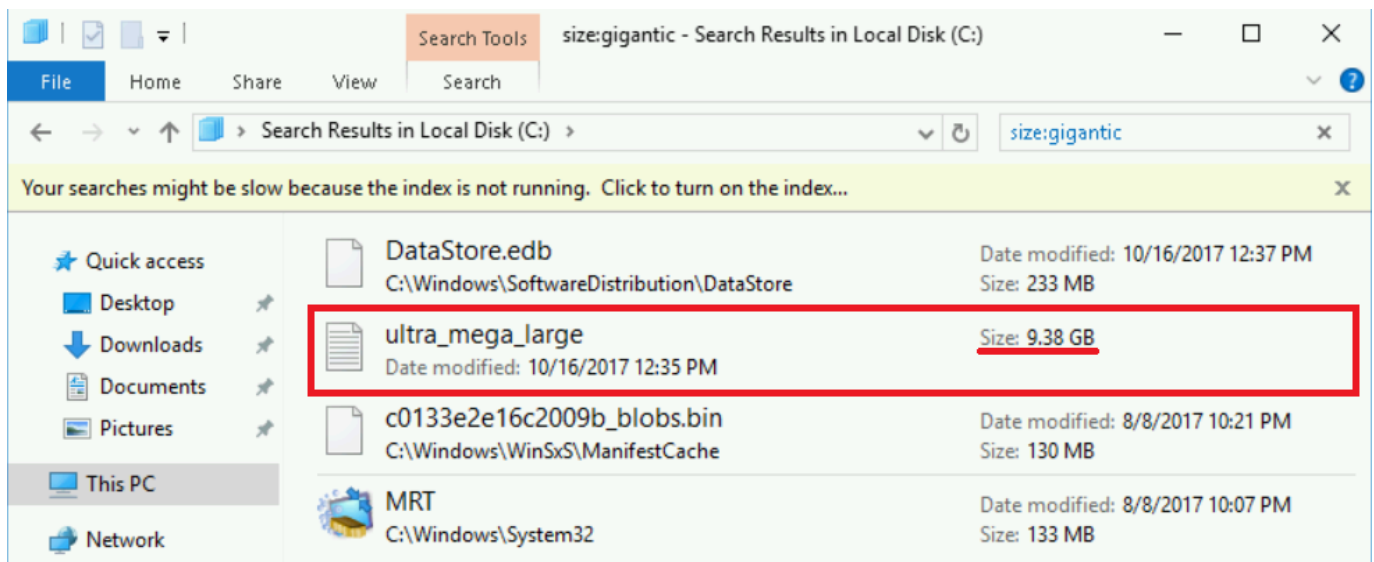
Open it and navigate to your C:\ directory, then click the search bar at the top right. A **Search Options** tab should appear. Click on it to view the different ways you can configure your search:



You're only interested in file size at the moment, so click the **Size** dropdown and choose **Gigantic** to start a search for files over 4 GB.

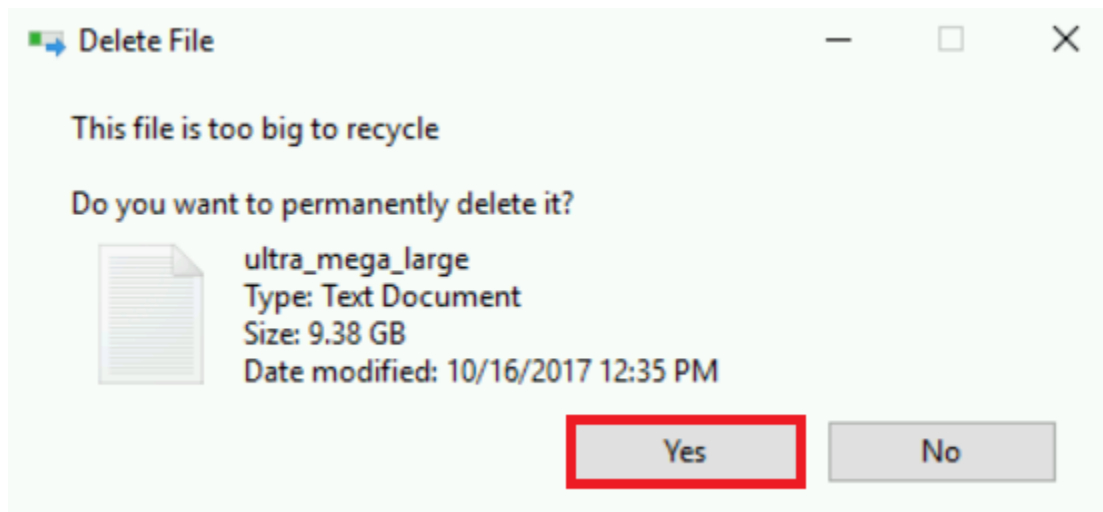


The search can take some time, and multiple files may appear in your search, but we're only interested in the largest (which is almost 10 gigabytes):



Now that you know which file is causing the low-memory error, you can delete it by right-clicking the file in the search results, and selecting **delete**.

Files over a certain size don't fit in the Windows **Recycle Bin**, and can only be permanently deleted. After clicking **Continue**, you'll see this message, indicating that the file is too large to recycle. Press **Yes** to delete permanently.



The file will delete, fixing the log issue! Note that the log will still remain in **Event Viewer**, because logs aren't deleted when the issues that caused them are removed.

The remaining log entries

Note: The following tasks in this lab require you to review tasks that you have completed in previous lab. You may refer back to those labs to review the steps.

The rest of the logs involve issues that you have already successfully fixed in earlier labs in this course. Refer back to those lessons and labs to refresh yourself on the required steps, if you're stuck:

Module 1 Lab: Creating, Modifying, and Removing Files and Folders in Windows

In a previous lab, you found and deleted files. Review the lab in Module 1 titled Creating, Modifying and Removing Folders and Files in Windows to remove a corrupted file.

First, you will navigate to the Users directory. Then, find the document named corrupted file and delete it.

Module 3 Lab: Software Packaging and File Archiving on Windows

In a previous lab, you updated out of date software. Review the lab in Module 3 titled Software Packaging and File Archiving on Windows to update the VLC media player.

You will need to update VLC. To do this, open the VLC Media Player, check for updates, and update VLC.

Module 5 Lab: Maintain Efficient Process Utilization on Windows

In a previous lab, you used commands to do some process maintenance on Windows. Review the lab in module 5 titled Maintain Efficient Processes on Windows to find and terminate a malicious process.

Use the Windows PowerShell to search for the process titled **totally_not_malicious**. Next, use the taskkill command with the **process ID** to terminate the process. To verify that the process is no longer running, you can search for the process again. This should throw an error because no process by that name exists anymore, indicating that you've successfully ended it.

Module 2 Lab: Creating, Modifying, and Removing File and Folder Permissions in Windows

In a previous lab, you learned how to manage user permissions on a Windows machine. You fixed permissions of some files and folders. Review the lab in module 2 to change the permissions of a secret file.

First, you need to navigate to the **Users\Temp** directory. Find the file named **super_secret_file.txt** and grant **write** permissions to everyone. You can view the permissions once they are granted to make sure it worked.

If you'd like to check your steps along the way, refer to your score in the top right of the lab. Click the score and run each step to check individually as you go. Good luck!

Conclusion

Congratulations! You've successfully used logs to track down and fix issues on a Windows machine. This is a crucial skill that you'll need to develop as an IT Support Specialist.
